



Michael Woodcock <mlw19mlw91@gmail.com>

Ongoing Violations and Public Safety Concerns at Short Term Rental Adjacent to Our Property

1 message

Michael Woodcock [REDACTED]

Wed, Feb 25, 2026 at 6:10 PM

To: hello@bookl.ee

I am submitting this complaint regarding the short-term vacation rental located next to our residence. The operation of this STR has repeatedly disrupted the residential character of our neighborhood and interfered with our quiet enjoyment of our property, in direct conflict with the obligations outlined in the Chatham County Short-Term Rental Ordinance and the Property Owner's Agreement.

Below is a summary of the ongoing issues:

1. Repeated Noise Disturbances and Late-Night Parties

We have experienced multiple incidents of loud parties continuing well into the early morning hours. On one occasion, guests informed us in advance that they intended to host a party; approximately **25 vehicles arrived around 11 PM**, and guests parked in a nearby church parking lot clearly marked "Parking for Church Only – Tow Away Zone." After the event, trash was left throughout the lot.

Guests were also observed walking through our yard, shining flashlights into our windows because they were unsure where to go. This created a significant safety concern for our household.

2. Property Damage and Trespass

There have been multiple instances of STR guests driving across our lawn. In one case, a vehicle became stuck, causing rutting and damage to the yard and requiring wrecker recovery. This is not only a nuisance but also a direct encroachment onto our property.

3. Serious Public Safety Incident — Shooting

A shooting occurred at this STR, during which **multiple homes and one vehicle were struck by gunfire**. This incident was reported in local news coverage and has raised substantial concern among neighbors regarding the safety of our community.

(Reference: Savannah Morning News article dated 9/25/2025 regarding the shooting at this STR.)

4. Occupancy Violations

The owner advertises the property as accommodating **10 guests**, despite the home containing only **3 bedrooms**. Under the County's occupancy rule - "*No more than two (2) adults per bedroom, plus two (2) additional adults*" - the maximum legal occupancy for this property is **8 persons**.

Advertising and hosting more than the permitted number of occupants is a direct violation of the STR regulations.

5. Failure to Prevent Nuisance and Maintain Neighborhood Standards

The STR owner has not met the ordinance requirement to "use his or her best efforts to assure that use of the premises by short-term rental occupants will not disrupt the neighborhood and will not interfere with the rights of neighboring property owners to the quiet enjoyment of their properties."

This requirement is explicitly stated in the County's STR application and Property Owner's Agreement.

The cumulative issues — noise, trespass, property damage, excessive occupancy, and a major violent incident — demonstrate a pattern of non-compliance and a failure to responsibly manage the rental.

Request for Review

Given the severity and frequency of these problems, we respectfully request that you:

- Review this STR's compliance with occupancy limits
- Confirm whether the owner is meeting the obligations of the STR ordinance
- Evaluate whether this property remains eligible for your platform
- Take any enforcement action deemed appropriate

Our goal is simply to restore safety, peace, and quiet enjoyment to our neighborhood.

Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Michael Woodcock

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